

The Theory of Rent Extraction and Contemporary China: Understanding the Land Nodal Point and Preparing for Strategic Transformation

White Paper

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Based on the Theory of Rent Extraction by Thierry REBOUR (1)

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Abstract: This white paper applies the Theory of Rent Extraction (TdR) to analyze China's current structural economic transition. The TdR demonstrates that every civilization undergoes cycles in which a dominant scarcity first drives growth, then becomes an obstacle upon saturation. After decades of rapid urbanization and industrialization, China is approaching the nodal point of its land rent extraction cycle. Absolute rent is absorbing systemic value, leading to falling returns on capital, a spreading real estate crisis, and rising local government debt. This report argues that the solution lies not in further investment in the old cycle, but in a strategic transition toward new dominant scarcities: energy, life resources, data, and artificial intelligence. It proposes operational policy recommendations across four domains—finance, ecology, health, and data governance—aimed at destroying the old rent's capacity to capture wealth through “creative destruction,” while simultaneously creating a monetization shock to initiate a new cycle of rent extraction. The white paper concludes that China, with its strategic planning capabilities, is well-positioned to proactively declare this nodal point, thereby preserving its performance-based governance legitimacy and offering an alternative development path to developing countries worldwide.

Keywords: Rent Extraction Theory, Absolute Rent, Differential Rent, Nodal Point, Land Transition, China, Urbanization, Real Estate Crisis, Energy Transition, Data Governance, Artificial Intelligence, Biosafety, Carbon Market, Policy Recommendations, Bruno DE DOMINICIS, Thierry REBOUR

Contents

White Paper	4
The Theory of Rent Extraction and Contemporary China: Understanding the Land Nodal Point and Preparing for Strategic Transformation	4
I. Introduction: A pivotal moment in Chinese economic history	4
II. The Theory of Rent Extraction: understanding cycles of dominant scarcity	4
III. Limitations of classical frameworks in the face of the nodal point	5
IV. Historical precedents: universal mutations	5
V. China’ s trajectory according to the Theory of Rent Extraction	6
VI. Quantified diagnosis: China at the nodal point	6
VII. Diagram of the rent extraction cycle	7
VIII. Paths of evolution: towards a new rent extraction	7
IX. Operational recommendations proposed by chat.qwen.ai	8
X. Operational recommendations proposed by z.ai, (drafted in July 2026)	9
XI. Conclusion: China at the crossroads of cycles and the mandate of the new cycle	11
Glossary (acronyms and technical terms)	11

White Paper

The Theory of Rent Extraction and Contemporary China: Understanding the Land Nodal Point and Preparing for Strategic Transformation

Presented for the attention of Chinese decision-makers September 2025, revised July 2026

I. Introduction: A pivotal moment in Chinese economic history

As highlighted in the *Opinion of the CPC Central Committee and the State Council on Promoting High-Quality Urban Development* (15 August 2025), China has entered a new phase: the transition from land development driven by massive expansion to development focused on improving the quality of the existing stock. This shift is not cyclical, but structural. In rent extraction theory, it corresponds to the approach of the land nodal point.

After decades of exceptional growth, driven by urbanisation, industrialisation and massive investment, returns on capital are eroding, the property crisis is spreading, and deflationary pressures are mounting. These phenomena are not anomalies, but signs of a deeper cyclical shift.

Classical analytical frameworks —neoclassical and Marxist—offer partial insights. But neither allows us to understand why, despite repeated reforms, the marginal productivity of capital continues to fall, nor how to find a sustainable way out of this situation.

It is here that the **Theory of Rent Extraction**^[^1] (**TdR**), developed by the economist and geographer Thierry Rebours^[^2], provides a novel analytical framework that enables us to grasp the **cyclical logic of dominant scarcities**. It demonstrates that every civilisation experiences phases in which a scarce resource becomes the driving force behind growth, only to become a hindrance once saturation is reached. This critical moment, known as the **nodal point**, requires not technical adjustments, but a **systemic mutation**.

China, drawing on its tradition of cyclical and strategic thinking, now finds itself at this crossroads. This report aims to demonstrate that the Theory of Rent Extraction provides a theoretical and analytical framework for the policies already being implemented in China. This framework can help to anticipate, steer and legitimise the ongoing transition with greater precision and control.

II. The Theory of Rent Extraction: understanding cycles of dominant scarcity

To grasp the dynamics of long-term economic development, one must first understand that any society prospers by gradually appropriating a scarce and strategic resource. This process, known as **rent extraction**, begins when this resource —which may be labour, land, energy, raw materials or data—initially monopolised and kept off the market (by the state or the Church, depending on the location and historical period)—is gradually monetised. As long as this dominant scarcity remains available for rent extraction, every investment generates new wealth, and growth continues.

But this process has a limit. Once the resource has been fully appropriated, it ceases to generate wealth. It is then that a shift occurs: **absolute rent** takes hold. Unlike differential rent, which rewards quality or effort, absolute rent depends solely on **ownership**. It automatically captures any rise in income, productivity or innovation, without creating any real wealth.

This moment is what the Theory of Rent Extraction calls the **nodal point**: not an accidental crisis, but the logical end of a cycle. At this stage, production no longer creates wealth—it destroys it, through debt,

social exclusion or over-accumulation. The solution does not lie in further investment within the same cycle, but in a **shift towards a new dominant scarcity**.

III. Limitations of classical frameworks in the face of the nodal point

Dominant economic approaches struggle to explain China's current situation. Rent Extraction Theory goes beyond them by offering a cyclical and systemic perspective.

The **neoclassical** approach attributes falling returns to “diminishing returns to capital” and “market rigidities”. Its response is clear: reform, deregulate, improve marginal efficiency. But this framework fails to recognise that, even with perfectly functioning markets, value can be captured by absolute rent. In China, we see efficiency gains in certain sectors, but an overall fall in the rate of return on capital — because wealth is being siphoned off by land, not because firms are inefficient.

As for the **Marxist** analysis, it articulates the law of the tendency of the rate of profit to fall, linked to automation and the decline in “living labour”. It captures a real aspect of accumulation, but overlooks the role of **successive dominant forms of scarcity**: slavery, land, energy, data, raw materials. It sees a general law where history shows a succession of cycles. In China, the crisis is not primarily one of the exploitation of labour, but of the **appropriation of surplus value by land**. A well-paid worker in Shenzhen cannot afford to buy a flat —not because they are exploited, but because land prices absorb their entire purchasing power.

The Theory of Rent Extraction, on the other hand, shows that **the decline in returns is not a malfunction, but the logical end of a cycle**. It helps us understand that the Chinese slowdown is not due to a lack of reforms, but to the **exhaustion of the urban pioneering frontier**, and that the property crisis is not a liquidity crisis, but a crisis of **land over-accumulation**.

IV. Historical precedents: universal mutations

The Chinese experience is not unique. Other civilisations have undergone comparable shifts.

In Rome, in the 3rd century, the Empire had been built on the scarcity of slaves supplied by its conquests. When expansion dried up, labour became scarce, and the slave system collapsed. Scarcity shifted to **land**, and the large estates imposed the **colocate** (a system of land dependency). It was no longer conquest that created wealth, but the ownership of land.

Similarly, in modern Europe, when the agricultural pioneering frontier closed, all land had already been surveyed and privatised. Absolute ground rent became the necessary prerequisite for all economic activity. No craftsman could work without renting a workshop, no trader could sell without acquiring a trading pitch. This impasse fuelled the revolutions of the 19th century. It was only with the **Industrial Revolution**, based on fossil fuels, that Europe was able to shift into a new cycle.

A particularly telling example for China is that of **post-war France**. In 1945, the country was emerging from a cycle of land rent extraction characterised by inequality and speculation. Faced with the threat of the working classes turning to communism, the French elites chose to **redistribute part of the land rent**: through the large-scale construction of social housing (HLM), the social security system, and tax reforms. This move was not merely a social one: it helped to **defuse social unrest**, finance industry, and kick-start the economic growth of the **Trente Glorieuses (1945–1975)**.

This case stands in stark contrast to that of the **Ming dynasty**, whose collapse in the 17th century was caused by its refusal to socialise agricultural rent. Whilst land was concentrated in the hands of a corrupt

aristocracy, the state refused to implement any major tax reforms. The burden fell on the peasants, who, burdened by debt, rose up in revolt. Li Zicheng's rebellion weakened the dynasty to the point of making it vulnerable to the Manchus.

These two examples —France and Ming-era China —show that **the management of land rent is not a secondary economic issue, but a matter of fundamental political stability**. When the state channels rent, it preserves social cohesion. When it leaves it in the hands of closed elites, it heads for crisis.

V. China's trajectory according to the Theory of Rent Extraction

Modern China has gone through a classic cycle of rent extraction, the phases of which correspond closely to the theory.

From 1980 to 2010, China's "pioneering frontier" was urbanisation and industrialisation. The **dominant scarcity** was cheap rural labour and land suitable for urban development. Every hectare of agricultural land converted, every factory built, every worker transferred from the countryside to the cities, generated new wealth. Returns on capital were exceptional, growth exceeded 10 per cent per year, and China integrated into the global market.

But from the 2010s onwards, the situation changed. Land available for urban development became scarce, labour costs rose, and investment —although massive —began to result in overcapacity in steel, cement and property. Local government debt skyrocketed, backed by the sale of land-use rights.

As Muyang Chen analyses, the Chinese development model has relied on an innovative financing mechanism: LGFVs borrow from the China Development Bank (CDB) by pledging future land revenue streams as collateral. This "virtuous circle" has enabled massive investment in infrastructure, but it rests on one condition: **land values must continue to rise**. Today, with falling property prices and saturated urban markets, this cycle is breaking down. We have entered the phase of **approaching the nodal point**: the marginal efficiency of capital has fallen, productivity has stagnated, and signs of saturation have multiplied.

Since 2020, the symptoms have become glaringly obvious. The collapse of Evergrande, Country Garden and other property giants reveals the sector's fragility. The return on capital is falling below the cost of capital in several industrial sectors, as shown by analyses from the IMF and the Rhodium Group. Housing is becoming unaffordable for a growing proportion of young people, putting pressure on birth rates and social cohesion.

This analysis applies to China's developed regions (primarily along the coasts), but not to the deep interior, which remains in a "pioneering frontier" state.

We are therefore at the **nodal point**: land rent has absorbed all the value. Building more no longer creates wealth —it destroys it, through debt, exclusion and declining birth rates.

VI. Quantified diagnosis: China at the nodal point

Economic data confirm this analysis:

- The property and construction sectors account for around **20 per cent of GDP**, and up to **30 per cent** if upstream and downstream sectors are included.
- The **return on invested capital (ROIC)** in Chinese industry is now below **6 per cent**, well below the cost of capital in many cases.

- **Local government debt** exceeds **40 per cent of GDP**, financed mainly through the sale of land-use rights.
- The **price-to-income ratio** stands at **30 to 40 times** in Shenzhen and Beijing, compared with 6 to 8 in major Western cities.
- The urbanisation rate is **65 per cent**, meaning that the urban pioneering frontier is virtually saturated.

These figures do not reflect failure, but rather **structural exhaustion**. The land rent extraction cycle has come to an end.

VII. Diagram of the rent extraction cycle

1- Dominant scarcity: labour	2- Dominant scarcity: land	3- Dominant scarcities: energy, data, living resources, raw materials
Open pioneering frontier (1980–2010) ⇓	Land saturation (2010–2020) ⇓	Strategic transformation (2025–?) ⇓
Differential land rent 1 and 2 ⇓	Dominant absolute land rent ⇓	New types of rent ⇓
Investment = value creation ⇓	Accumulation = value destruction ⇓	New growth cycle ⇓
Strong growth, employment, GDP	Property crisis, exclusion, debt	Green energy, AI, biotech, rare earths, etc.

Table 1: Diagram of the rent extraction cycle

This diagram illustrates the inevitable logic of the cycle. China is currently at the central arrow: **land rent extraction is complete; the nodal point has been reached**.

VIII. Paths of evolution: towards a new rent extraction

China does not have to endure this transformation —it can **steer** it. Four new dominant forms of scarcity are emerging:

1. Energy and ecological transition Mastery of renewable energy, energy storage and hydrogen could become the next driver of growth. China already accounts for 70 per cent of global solar panel production and 60 per cent of battery production. By extending its Emissions Trading Scheme (ETS) to steel, cement and aluminium, it can transform this technological lead into a **sustainable strategic rent**.

2. The living: health, biotechnologies, food In a country facing rapid population ageing, harnessing the potential of the living —health, genomics, precision agriculture —can meet domestic demand whilst offering a global competitive advantage. The framework provided by the Biosecurity Act and the PIPL

allows this scarce resource to be managed under sovereign control, preventing the unchecked privatisation of clinical data.

3. Data and AI Digital technology and artificial intelligence open up the possibility of extracting rent from data as a scarce resource. Control over platforms, data flows and international standards would give China a sustainable **cognitive rent**, analogous to that which the West derived from oil in the 20th century.

4. Refining and controlling the supply of critical materials Finally, China can transform its dominant position in the mining and refining of rare earths, lithium and cobalt into a **transformation rent**. Rather than selling raw ores, it can impose standards and differentiated taxes, and reinvest the revenue in the energy transition and healthcare.

IX. Operational recommendations proposed by chat.qwen.ai

1) Ministry of Finance (MOF) & National Development and Reform Commission (NDRC) Within 12 months:

- Pilot scheme for a **recurring property tax** in 10 major cities (land registry + digital collection).
- Conversion of **unsold property** into affordable housing (保障性住房) via bridge funds financed by the PBOC.
- Gradual reduction of local governments' dependence on the sale of land-use rights.

Within 24 months:

- Expansion of the pilot scheme to 30 cities.
- Creation of a **national land transition fund** financed by tax revenue.

KPIs: Collection rate > 90% by 2026; local debt-to-stable revenue ratio < 1.5.

2) Ministry of Ecology and Environment (MEE) & NDRC Within 12 months:

- Official extension of the **national ETS** to cement, steel and aluminium.
- Introduction of a single **MRV** (Monitoring, Reporting, Verification) protocol.

Within 24 months:

- Launch of regional capacity markets to remunerate storage and demand response.
- Publication of a national standard for long-term **PPA** (Power Purchase Agreements).

KPIs: Share of demand growth met by renewables > 80% by 2027; 15% reduction in the carbon intensity of heavy industry by 2030.

3) National Health Commission (NHC) & National Medical Products Administration (NMPA) Within 12 months:

- Acceleration of clinical trial procedures (phased submissions, multi-centre trials).
- Establishment of **health data sandboxes** compliant with the PIPL for research purposes.

Within 24 months:

- Expansion of the **national NRDL list** to include more innovative domestic products.

- Introduction of performance-based reimbursement contracts.

KPIs: Average time to clinical trial authorisation reduced by 30 per cent by 2026; proportion of “China-first” Phase III trials > 20 per cent in 2027.

4) Cyberspace Administration of China (CAC) & Local data exchanges (Shanghai, Beijing) Within 12 months:

- Publication of national standards for data usage contracts (duration, purpose, traceability).
- Establishment of an interoperable catalogue of “gold” datasets available for exchange.

Within 24 months:

- Roll-out of a **data dividend** mechanism (partial payout to local authorities and source institutions).
- Clarification of cross-border transfer rules in conjunction with the PIPL and the DSL.

KPIs: Volume of certified exchanges on Data Exchanges $\times 5$ by 2027; number of certified interoperable datasets > 100,000.

X. Operational recommendations proposed by z.ai, (drafted in July 2026)

The Theory of Rent Extraction teaches an inescapable truth: one cannot break free from a nodal point through marginal adjustments. The transition from one cycle to another is not a linear evolution; it is a **destructive and creative mutation**. As long as absolute land rent continues to siphon off value from the system, the new sectors (AI, green energy, biotech) will be unable to become the dominant drivers of the economy: they will be stifled by the structural cost of access to land.

To steer this transition, China must not merely “develop” new industries; it must **destroy the old cycle’s capacity to capture wealth**, whilst simultaneously **creating the monetisation shock** that will trigger the new rent extraction.

1. The creative destruction of the old rent: purging the land system It is impossible to graft a cycle of innovation onto a system suffocated by property rent. The first step is to shatter the expectation of absolute rent.

A. The structural bankruptcy of LGFVs and the socialisation of the vacant housing stock:

The artificial propping up of local financing vehicles (LGFVs), secured against devalued land assets, constitutes a debt trap. The Rent Extraction theory requires us to acknowledge the destruction of value: the central government must force the restructuring or even the bankruptcy of the most exposed LGFVs. In exchange, the vacant housing stock and undeveloped land are confiscated and transferred to Sovereign Transition Funds. This stock is no longer a speculative commodity, but a common good (social housing at marginal cost), thereby destroying the artificial scarcity that underpinned absolute rent.

B. The fiscal weapon of absolute rent (Property Tax):

The recurrent property tax is not merely a budgetary tool; it is the theoretical instrument for the destruction of absolute rent. By taxing the value of the land (rather than the buildings) on a progressive basis for second homes, vacant properties and speculators, the State effects a compulsory transfer: the wealth tied up in land is channelled back into the State budget to finance the new cycle. Land ceases to be an unproductive form of savings.

2. Managing geographical duality: the asymmetry of pioneering frontiers It would be a mistake to apply a uniform policy. Rebour's theory emphasises the spatial dimension: cycles do not occur simultaneously everywhere.

A. Coastal China: in a nodal point phase (de-morphogenesis):

The eastern metropolises (Shanghai, Shenzhen, Beijing) have reached land saturation. Their radial morphology (overvalued centres, pushed-out peripheries) is the spatial symptom of absolute rent. Urban policy there must break with the model of urban sprawl: selective densification, freeing up space for productive activity (forced reduction in commercial rents), and a halt to major infrastructure expansion projects whose marginal return has become negative.

B. Inland China: maintaining the pioneering frontier (re-morphogenesis):

The deep interior retains scope for land rent extraction. For these regions, urbanisation remains a legitimate driver of growth. The strategy must be asymmetrical: allowing second- and third-tier cities to complete their urbanisation cycle, whilst first-tier cities shift en masse towards the new cycle. The central government must prevent the transfer of coastal property speculation to the interior, which would prematurely destroy the "pioneering frontier" in these provinces.

3. The monetisation shock: initiating the "Rent Extraction" of new scarcities The transition during France's Trente Glorieuses or Deng's 1978 reform was based on a massive monetisation shock: bringing a resource previously outside the market (land, labour) onto the market. For AI, energy or living organisms to become the new "dominant scarcity", the state must create the conditions for their rent extraction by the economy.

A. Rent Extraction of "Life" (Biosecurity and Health as a strategic rent):

Ageing is not merely a demographic burden; it is the new frontier of scarcity: healthy life expectancy. Monetisation takes place through the establishment of "Sovereign Health Data Trusts". The genomic and clinical data of 1.4 billion citizens, previously fragmented, are organised as productive capital. Biotech companies (whether domestic or foreign) no longer merely pay for patents; they "purchase" access rights to this living capital, generating a massive differential rent for the State, which is reinvested in hospital infrastructure.

B. Rent Extraction of "Carbon and Energy" (The ETS as the 21st-century land market):

The carbon market (ETS) must not be merely a regulatory tax. It must become the new "land" market. The initial allocation of emission allowances creates a scarce resource. By making these allowances increasingly restrictive (reducing supply), the state drives up the value of carbon. Companies must "purchase" the right to pollute. The carbon rent thus captured by the state replaces local governments' land rent, financing the energy transition in exactly the same way that the sale of land-use rights financed infrastructure in the 2000s.

C. Rent Extraction of "Cognitive Data" :

The Chinese state has nationalised data (PIPL, DSL). But nationalisation is not the same as rent extraction. It must be monetised. The Data Exchanges (Shanghai, Beijing) must function as exchanges for cognitive commodities. Platforms (Alibaba, Tencent, ByteDance) are compelled to "purchase" AI training licences from public agencies, thereby transferring cognitive surplus value from the private oligopoly to public funding for the new cycle.

4. The morphological mutation: towards post-land space In structural geography, land rent gives rise to the concentric city and urban sprawl (the car-and-detached-house model). The new scarcity (data, energy, living organisms) will produce new spatial morphologies.

- The city of the land-based cycle is **centripetal**: value lies at the centre (CBD), whilst transport and time costs are externalised onto workers.
- The city of the data and energy cycle must be **nodal and reticular**: value no longer lies in physical centrality, but in instantaneous connectivity (edge computing, smart grids). Planning policies must cease subsidising physical transport to hyper-centres, and invest heavily in energy and digital decentralisation (micro-grids, distributed data centres, genuine “15-minute cities” based on proximity to community life and care, rather than solely on service sector employment).

XI. Conclusion: China at the crossroads of cycles and the mandate of the new cycle

The CCP has built its contemporary legitimacy on the promise of development through mass urbanisation. The official document on the *promotion of high-quality urban development* dated 15-08-2025 marks a turning point: it formalises the end of the development model based on land expansion. This cycle is complete. Attempting to prolong it through property booms or local debt plans would only entrench absolute rent, leading to Japanese-style stagnation, or worse, a Ming-style dynastic collapse.

The Theory of Rent Extraction shows that the greatest powers are those that do not succumb to the nodal point, but **declare** it. By dismantling the property sector’s ability to absorb savings, and by creating the carbon and cognitive data markets, China is not abandoning its model: it is setting in motion its third great rent extraction (following the 1950 land reform and Deng’s opening-up in 1978). It is at this cost that the Mandate of Heaven of the modern era is preserved: economic performance in the service of social cohesion.

This strategic mutation is not merely internal: as Muyang Chen demonstrates, China is already reinventing the rules of development financing on a global scale. By steering the transition towards a new dominant scarcity —energy, the living, data, raw materials—China is doing more than simply stabilising its domestic model. As Eric Li and Graham Allison point out, the Chinese model of governance is based on **legitimacy through performance**: stability, development and improved well-being. Moving beyond the land nodal point is not merely an economic necessity, but a **condition of this legitimacy**.

By proactively steering this shift, China is **strengthening its position as a hub of alternative governance**, offering developing nations a path to development based on stability, long-term planning and technological sovereignty. The Theory of Rent Extraction provides a framework for theorising this inevitable transition. Through its strategic vision and pragmatism, China is in a position to **define the next global cycle**.

Glossary (acronyms and technical terms)

- **ROIC**: Return on Invested Capital.
- **ICOR**: Incremental Capital Output Ratio.
- **MOF**: Ministry of Finance.
- **NDRC**: National Development and Reform Commission.
- **MEE**: Ministry of Ecology and Environment.
- **NHC**: National Health Commission.
- **NMPA**: National Medical Products Administration.

- **CAC**: Cyberspace Administration of China.
- **PBOC**: People's Bank of China.
- **ETS**: Emissions Trading System.
- **MRV**: Monitoring, Reporting, Verification.
- **PPA**: Power Purchase Agreement.
- **NRDL**: National Reimbursement Drug List.
- **PIPL**: Personal Information Protection Law.
- **DSL**: Data Security Law.
- **BRI**: Belt and Road Initiative.
- **HLM**: Social housing (Habitation à Loyer Modéré).
- **VAT**: Value Added Tax.
- **LGFV**: Local Government Financing Vehicle.
- **EV**: Electric Vehicle.
- **KPI**: Key Performance Indicator.

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Muyang Chen, *The Latecomer's Rise: Policy Banks and the Globalization of China's Development Finance (Cornell Studies in Money)*, Lightning Source Inc. (Tier 3), PS, 2024 <https://annas-archive.org/md5/431d641aef3562193da169b9815baab7>

Eric Li, Graham Allison, **Party Life : Chinese Governance and the World Beyond Liberalism**, Palgrave Macmillan, Springer Nature, Singapore, 2023 <https://annas-archive.org/md5/8cb7eeea0b5df09b709d72cf25ba>

Éric Stemmelen, **The Religion of the Lords - A History of the Rise of Christianity between the 1st and 6th Century**, Ed. Michalon, Paris, France, 2010 <https://annas-archive.org/md5/7e9bdfc802be52ca856770b>

Further reading on structural geography

Gilles Ritchot (1935-2021), the founder of the School of Structural Geography at Laval University in Quebec, his biography: <https://cybergeog.hypotheses.org/911>

Gaëtan Desmarais and Gilles Ritchot, **Structural Geography** (148 pages) The best presentation available in Kindle format, to be translated into Chinese! Amazon link: <https://www.amazon.fr/G%C3%89OGRAPHIE-STRUCTURALE-Gilles-Ritchot-ebook/dp/B0F134BJSR>

Beyond fads and conceptual transfers, authentically structuralist geographical works are becoming rare today. It is not enough to claim the concept of “structure” and to propose a metaphorical use of it to achieve scientific innovation. The fecundity and relevance of the structural approach in geography depend primarily on the ability to forge original theoretical concepts based on a choice of morphological and dynamic objects, which allows conferring unity to the discipline and resolving some of its most essential problems. Such is the ambition of this work. It was born from the encounter and dialogue between two researchers

driven by the same project; one having initiated and developed the structural approach in geomorphology and human geography for nearly forty years, the other having extended these pioneering works by deepening the convergent contributions of structural epistemology, semiotics, and morphodynamic models. At once an ordered synthesis and a systematic exposition of the multiple aspects of a geography that does not separate structure, genesis, and spatiality, this book addresses fundamental problems that are decisive for the discipline. It provides an opportunity to reflect on the possibility of constituting a true theoretical geography in conjunction with analyses that conform to the intelligence of the facts.

Gaëtan Desmarais, **Three Key Concepts for Morphodynamic Models of the City** <https://www.erudit.org/fr/revues/cgq/1998-v42-n117-cgq2689/022765ar> This article examines three key concepts essential to the study of city morphogenesis. It first deals with the organizing centre of cities, that is to say, their origin, their attractiveness, their investment of meaning, and their permanence over the long term. It then identifies the spatial interaction schemes that are relevant to conceive in order to ensure the transition from the micro-geographical level of actors and their multiple actions to the meso-geographical level of forms structuring the internal spatial organization of cities. Finally, it explicates a dynamic model of anisotropic space. This model makes it possible to reconstruct the way in which morphogenetic gradients differentiate the internal space of cities into qualitatively distinct domains. Examples drawn from the morphogenesis of Paris are used.

Gilles Ritchot, **The Morphogenesis of Rome: From Initial Discontinuity to Current Sprawl** Editions L' Harmattan, L' Harmattan Edition Diffusion, [N.p.], 2011 <https://annas-archive.org/md5/25eb85121ec8ed6ca84857ddb501839> For centuries, Rome organized the Mediterranean and European area. Its morphogenesis was twofold. The first culminated with the ancient Empire and bequeathed its legal system to the West. Then Rome, having become a “field of ruins”, evolved as a reservoir of values. Christendom resumed the imperial journey in a second morphogenesis, pitting Germanic sovereigns against the kings of France. This formidable human tectonics positioned the 3 monotheistic cultures on the 5 continents.

An article by the author of this report:

Bruno De Dominicis, **From Jewish Hermeneutics to Urban Morphodynamics in the Light of the Anthropology of Dogma: a contribution to the sciences of form.** (2001) <https://id.erudit.org/iderudit/022943ar>

A commentary on Genesis 2,7-14 according to Jewish hermeneutic rules reveals a dynamics of spatialization of categories along two oriented axes. This scheme is compared to the Parisian morphogenesis as described by Gaëtan Desmarais, who imported René Thom's catastrophe theory into the study of urban establishment. The works of Pierre Legendre, founder of the anthropology of dogma, make it possible to show that the analogies and gaps between these schemes conform to the structural relationships prevailing between Judaism and Christianity.

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